O. Cost Management & Resource Accounting

Standalone capability brief · Suggested module: **FinOps + Resource Accounting**

Purpose

Attribute shared infrastructure consumption to the tenants, projects, services, and environments that cause it, then make cost, budget, and capacity signals actionable.

1. Scope and capability areas

Usage attribution

Capture resource consumption with stable resource IDs, ownership tags, units, and time windows.

Allocation and reporting

Allocate shared and direct costs by tenant, project, service, and environment using documented methods.

Budgets and alerts

Support thresholds, forecasts, notifications, and escalation paths.

Resource ownership

Require cost owner, environment, service, and lifecycle metadata on billable resources.

Waste detection

Identify idle resources, oversized workloads, orphaned storage, and unused reserved capacity.

Forecasting

Estimate future spend and capacity needs from trends and planned growth.

Showback and chargeback

Provide transparent usage reporting and, where required, chargeback calculations.

2. Shared contracts and standards

- Cost data includes source, unit, time interval, allocation method, and confidence or quality status.
- Shared costs use documented allocation rules and are distinguishable from directly attributable costs.
- Budgets trigger defined actions but should not unexpectedly interrupt critical workloads.
- Resource metadata requirements are enforced at provisioning and periodically audited.

3. Recommended implementation approach

- Ingest cloud and platform usage data into a normalized accounting model.
- Join usage to authoritative tenant, project, service, and environment ownership records.
- Create dashboards for spend, unit economics, budget variance, and resource efficiency.
- Provide recommendations with estimated savings and risk context.
- Reconcile platform accounting data with provider invoices and billing exports.

4. Failure behavior and operational expectations

- If usage data is delayed or incomplete, label reports as provisional and expose the missing interval.
- Allocation changes must be versioned so historical reports remain explainable.
- Automated cleanup should require safeguards for production resources and preserve recovery options.

5. Suggested operational metrics

- Percentage of spend with known owner
- Invoice reconciliation variance
- Budget forecast accuracy
- Idle-resource spend
- Cost per tenant or unit of product value

6. Readiness and acceptance checklist

- [ ] Most platform spend is attributable or explicitly marked shared/unallocated.
- [ ] Budget alerts have clear owners and actions.
- [ ] Reports can be reconciled to source invoices.
- [ ] Optimization recommendations quantify savings and operational risk.

Ownership note: assign a named team, service owner, support route, versioning policy, and deprecation process before treating this capability as a platform contract.